ACTIVITY 2

Translate a Process into an Audit Trail

ISO 9001 Quality Management System (QMS) Internal Auditor Training
TGS-2023039341 · K1 · A1 · LO1 · 60 minutes

Objective

Use the process approach to turn inputs, activities, controls, outputs and interfaces into a focused audit trail.

Scenario

MPS accepts custom orders that require engineering review, supplier purchasing, production, inspection and delivery. Recent rework suggests that changed customer drawings do not always reach production and inspection in time. The audit must determine whether the end-to-end change flow is controlled and effective.

Materials

- Order-to-delivery narrative and sample records in the activity PDF
- Process mapping and audit-trail sheets in the workbook
- Clause and evidence prompts from the Learner Guide

Activity questions

- Where does the process start and end, and who owns the intended result?
- Which interfaces create the greatest risk of an outdated requirement being used?
- What combination of record, interview and observation evidence would test each critical control?
- How will one sample be traced forward and backward across the process?

Required evidence

- Process map
- Control and evidence matrix
- Forward/backward audit trail
- Audit question set

Detailed Procedure

1. Define the process purpose, customer, boundaries and intended output. Write the purpose as a result, not an activity label.

2. Identify suppliers and inputs, including customer specifications, regulatory needs and internal planning information.

3. Map the major process stages from enquiry review through release and delivery. Show decision points and hand-offs.

4. For each stage, identify the responsible role, control, risk and retained evidence.

5. Mark the two interfaces most likely to allow an obsolete drawing or requirement to pass downstream.

6. Select one real-looking order identifier from the scenario. Design a forward trace from requirement to delivery and a backward trace from released output to original requirement.

7. Write audit questions that ask what, how, when, who and show-me; avoid closed questions that invite only yes/no answers.

8. Specify how evidence will be triangulated through record review, interview and observation.

9. Review the trail against the activity checklist and revise any question that lacks a clear criterion or evidence expectation.

Acceptance Check

The map shows clear boundaries and interfaces, and each critical audit question identifies a criterion, evidence source and trace direction.

Learner completion checklist

Done	Evidence / output	Reviewer comment
■	Process map	
■	Control and evidence matrix	
■	Forward/backward audit trail	
■	Audit question set	